A Sale, a Large Deposit, a New Account: Money Events in Dad's Year Worth a Dated Note

Fifteen everyday events to notice and write down as they happen, with no judging what any of them means.

Dad sold the truck last spring and moved some savings to a new bank in the fall. This year everyone remembers the details, which makes this the easy year to write them down.

This guide names fifteen everyday money events worth a dated note and, for each, what to write down. Ask Dad first. They're his finances, and the noting is something to do with him.

Notice and note. Don't interpret. The federal Administration for Community Living says a state may ask a Medicaid applicant to explain what happened to assets whose value went down a lot in the years before applying. Whether any event on this page matters for an application depends on the state and the situation, and that is a question for a professional. The kinds of events come from the Medicaid Planning Roadmap's lesson on keeping a transaction history; the items that follow a public source are marked, and the wording about what to write down is ours.

Money moving in and out

1 A deposit that isn't one of the regular ones

NOTICE An amount on a statement that isn't Social Security, a pension or another deposit that shows up every month: a tax refund, an inheritance, the money from something sold.

WRITE DOWN The date, where it came from in Dad's words, and where any letter or check stub that came with it is kept.

2 A withdrawal or a check that stands out

NOTICE A cash withdrawal, a cashier's check or a payment that isn't part of Dad's ordinary month: a new roof, a used car, a trip.

WRITE DOWN The date, what it was for as Dad tells it, and the receipt or invoice if there is one.

3 Money moved between Dad's own accounts

NOTICE Savings moved to checking, a certificate of deposit that matured and went somewhere else, one retirement account rolled into another.

WRITE DOWN The date, the account it left and the account it went to. Both statements will show it; note where they are.

4 A gift

NOTICE Money or something of value Dad gave to a child, a grandchild, a friend, a church or a charity: a check at graduation, help with a down payment, a car handed down.

WRITE DOWN What was given, to whom and roughly when, plus any card, note or canceled check. Record it. Don't weigh it.

Accounts and statements

5 **An account opened or closed** [2]

NOTICE A new bank's name on an envelope, an account Dad closed or combined with another.

WRITE DOWN The institution, the kind of account, the date it opened or closed, and where its first or last statement is.

6 **A statement that stops coming in the mail** [2]

NOTICE A statement that used to arrive on paper and now doesn't, because it went online or the account changed.

WRITE DOWN Which account it is, and how Dad gets the statement now.

7 **A change in what comes in each month** [3] [2]

NOTICE A new amount for Social Security or a pension, a benefit that started or stopped, a letter announcing the change.

WRITE DOWN The date of the letter, who sent it and where it's filed. Copy amounts as printed; don't estimate.

Property and things with a title

8 **Something sold**

NOTICE A vehicle, a boat, a piece of land, a collection.

WRITE DOWN What it was, the date, who bought it, and where the bill of sale or closing papers are.

9 **Paper about the house** [1]

NOTICE A property tax bill, an appraisal, a refinance, a home equity loan, a mortgage paid off.

WRITE DOWN What the paper is, its date, and where it's kept. The deed's place too, if you know it.

10 **A change in whose name is on something**

NOTICE A name added to or taken off a deed, a title or an account, when Dad mentions it or the paper shows it.

WRITE DOWN What changed, when, and where the paper showing it is. Write it as it happened, with no opinion attached.

Insurance, trusts and annuities

11 **An insurance policy that changes** [4]

NOTICE A life or long-term care policy that was started, cashed in, allowed to end or paid a claim; a renewal notice that looks different from last year's.

WRITE DOWN The company, the kind of policy, what changed and when, and where the policy is kept. Not what it covers.

12 A trust or annuity paper

NOTICE A statement from an annuity company, a letter from a trustee, a trust document Dad signed or changed.

WRITE DOWN That it exists, its date, who sent it and where it's kept. What it means is a question for your Medicaid planner or an elder law attorney.

People and the file itself

13 Something Dad mentions in passing

NOTICE “I helped your cousin out a while back.” “I moved some things around at the bank.” A remark over coffee can be the only record of an event.

WRITE DOWN His words, the date he said it, and what he remembers about when it happened and what paper there is.

14 The same events for Dad's spouse, if he is married

NOTICE A sale, a gift, a new account or an out-of-the-ordinary deposit or withdrawal in a spouse's name.

WRITE DOWN The same three things: what happened, when, and what paperwork exists.

15 The date on the file [2] [4]

NOTICE How long it has been since anyone added a line, and whether an account or a policy on your list has changed since.

WRITE DOWN The date of the last update at the top of the page, and who made it.

When a note isn't enough

If Dad or anyone in the family is thinking about making a gift, changing whose name is on an account or a property, or moving money because of what it might mean for Medicaid, that is a conversation to have with your Medicaid planner or an elder law attorney first. The same goes for any event you've written down and find yourself wondering about: bring the note and ask. This page can't say what an event means, and nothing on it is a reason to make, change or undo one.

What this guide doesn't do

It doesn't say what any of these events means for Medicaid, how far back a state looks, or how Dad's situation stands. It doesn't suggest any change to an account or a property. Nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You know which events in Dad's finances to jot down, with the date and the paperwork. The planning interview is the next step: it asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for care.

Get Your Free Planning Report ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

1. Administration for Community Living (LongTermCare.gov), Applying for Medicaid
2. Consumer Financial Protection Bureau, Planning for diminished capacity and illness
3. Administration for Community Living (LongTermCare.gov), Medicaid Eligibility
4. National Institute on Aging, Getting Your Affairs in Order Checklist: Documents to Prepare for the Future

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